ICAR - Sugarcane Breeding Institute Extension Bulletin

Title: Sugarcane Smut and Sett Rot Prevention in Maharashtra

Author: ICAR-SBI Pathology Division, Coimbatore & MPKV Rahuri

Year: 2024 | Language: English | Geographic Scope: Western Maharashtra

Symptoms and Identification

Sugarcane Smut (Sporisorium scitamineum) produces a diagnostic whip-like, curved black sorus at the apical shoot. Primary infection spreads via contaminated setts, while secondary spread occurs through wind-borne chlamydospores. Infected stools produce numerous thin, erect, grassy tillers with narrow leaves and suppressed internode elongation. Early detection in seed nurseries is essential to prevent regional transmission across sugar factory command areas.

Sett Treatment & Chemical Management

1. Certified Seed Selection: Select setts strictly from disease-free 8-10 month old
2. Moist Hot Air Treatment: Subject setts to 54 degrees C for 2.5 hours at 95% rela
3. Fungicidal Dip: Treat setts with Carbendazim 50% WP @ 1.0 g per litre of water
4. Foliar Spray: In standing crops with early whip emergence, rogue out whips in then spray Propiconazole 25% EC @ 1.0 ml per litre of water. CIBRC PHI: 30 days.